

Leah Boustan

Data for “School Desegregation and Urban Change: Evidence from City Boundaries.” *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*

Prepared on May 9, 2011

1980 block-level data

1. request1980_all.dta

This file contains two-digit state FIPS codes, three-digit county FIPS codes and six-digit tract codes for every tract in the border dataset in 1980. This file is to be merged with electronic Census block-level data.

2. census1980.do, CEN80.SF1.dct

The do-file (census1980.do) reads in electronic Census block-level data by state from ICPSR file 7975 using the dictionary file CEN80.SF1. It then merges the full block data with the tract request in request1980_all.dta, and keeps only those tracts in the border area dataset. (Note: Census data not included in this package. It is easily downloadable at ICPSR).

3. census1980_01.do

This do file prepares the electronic Census block-level data compiled state-by-state in census1980.do to be used in the analysis. It defines the dependent variable (e.g., housing values and rents) and the small number of available block-level control variables.

4. census1980_01.dta

Outcome data of running census1980.do and census1980_01.do.

5. tiercode1980.dta

This file contains codes for distance of each block from the school district/jurisdiction border (variable = tierno). This dataset was collected by hand in four different waves, indicated by the variable ‘dataset’. Note that this file also contains the cross-walk between the tract codes in 1970 and 1980 (1970 = ‘tract_1970’ and 1980 = ‘tract’).

6. merge_blockdata_1980.do

This do file combines data from four sources in 1980: indicators of distance from the border at the block level (from tiercode1980.dta); block-level characteristics (from census1980_01.dta) and two school district-level datasets (in the District_level folder).

7. blockdata_1980.dta

Outcome data of running merge_blockdata_1980.do. Along with data from 1970, this file is used to create the final results.